

By his very nature as a character, Iron Man is going to find his way into many a scrape. Saunders had to suggest through his design work how the literal translation of those scrapes, abrasions and scars would look on the armor. This study in armor battle damage (above) was a simple paintover of an already- existing publicity shot.

SAUNDERS: "We needed an idea of how the armor would look after Iron Monger got his paws on the hero. One of the difficulties in this was that it was going to be very expensive to create a second set of armor purely to showcase battle damage. We thought, this thing is metal, so how will it buckle when he gets punched? What will the bullet holes look like? Does the paint chip?"



So much time was spent on developing Iron Man's front view — the predominantly featured part of the armor throughout the movie — that it was easy to forget how much work needed to be done on back-armor concepts. Saunders developed these two sketches (left, below) in a bid to give an aerodynamic flair to anatomical features like shoulder blades, spinal cord and rib cage. In the end, the designs were deemed too "fishy," less aerodynamic and more aquatic-looking.

